Swimmer Archie Goodburn Helps Get New Help for Brain Cancer Patients

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Archie Goodburn is a 25-year-old swimmer from Scotland. Two years ago, doctors found three brain **tumors** that they cannot remove with **surgery**. He has had other treatments. He still kept racing and reached a final at the 2026 **Commonwealth Games** in Glasgow.

Goodburn asked on TV for more money for brain cancer **research**. Then the United Kingdom's **prime minister**, Andy Burnham, invited him to meet.

After the meeting, Burnham announced new plans. The government will pick a national leader for brain cancer care. It will also study what is slowing progress, and it wants to get new treatments to patients faster.

Goodburn thanked the **prime minister**. He said his three requests were "promised to some extent," but the details still need work.

Burnham called Goodburn "an inspiration to us all." He said, "Families facing this disease can't afford to wait."

Word Treasure

tumors -- Tumors are lumps of cells that grow in the body when they should not.

surgery -- Surgery is when doctors operate on a person's body to fix a problem.

Commonwealth Games -- The Commonwealth Games is a big sports event for athletes from many countries.

prime minister -- A prime minister is the leader of the government in some countries, like the United Kingdom.

research -- Research is careful study to learn new things, like how to treat an illness.

Background you need

Brain cancer is an illness that can be very hard to treat.

In the United Kingdom, the prime minister leads the government.

Scientists study new treatments so doctors can help patients better.

Break it down

WHO: Scottish swimmer Archie Goodburn and Prime Minister Andy Burnham
WHAT: The government announced new plans to improve brain cancer care
WHERE: In the United Kingdom, after a meeting with the prime minister
WHY: Goodburn, who has brain tumors, asked on TV for more money for brain cancer research

Why it matters

It shows that one person speaking up can help get leaders to act and help many patients.

Test what you remember

1. Where is Archie Goodburn from?

- (A) Australia
- (B) Canada
- (C) Japan
- (D) Scotland

2. How old is Goodburn?

- (A) 40
- (B) 12
- (C) 60
- (D) 25

3. Where were the 2026 Commonwealth Games held?

- (A) Glasgow
- (B) Tokyo
- (C) Paris
- (D) London

4. What did Goodburn ask for on TV?

- (A) A gold medal
- (B) A day off school
- (C) A new pool
- (D) More money for brain cancer research

5. Who invited Goodburn to meet?

- (A) His swim coach
- (B) Prime Minister Andy Burnham
- (C) A movie star
- (D) The Pope

6. What did Burnham call Goodburn?

- (A) "An inspiration to us all"
- (B) "A great singer"
- (C) "A champion chef"
- (D) "Too young"

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: D 2: D 3: A 4: D 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. Archie Goodburn: He thanked the prime minister and said his requests were "promised to some extent."

2. Andy Burnham: He said families facing the disease "can't afford to wait."

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):